Geography, weather and the planet

1. Read the article once for meaning. 2. Read it again and look at the **highlighted new words** and the **blue phrases** in context. 3. Study the tables. 4. Use at least 5 new words in speaking or writing this week.

Article: Our restless planet (172 words)

The surface of the Earth is constantly shaped by natural forces. The outer **crust** is broken into plates whose movement causes an **earthquake** or forces a **volcano** to erupt. Over millions of years, **erosion** wears down mountains, rivers carve valleys, and a slow-moving **glacier** cuts the **terrain** and leaves a new **landscape**. A **tributary** feeds a larger river, and **altitude** changes the climate: the higher you climb, the colder it becomes.

Weather and climate follow patterns. **Latitude** decides which regions are **tropical**, and warm or cold **ocean current** flows distribute heat around the globe. Parts of the world are **arid**, with little rain, while others are **humid** and wet. Each **season** brings its own conditions, but extreme events are becoming more frequent: a violent **hurricane** or sudden **flood** can destroy a town overnight, and **sea level** rise threatens low-lying coasts.

The **atmosphere** protects life from harmful radiation, but changing **tide** patterns and warming seas show how closely everything is connected. Understanding these processes helps us **brace ourselves for** natural disasters and **adapt to** change.

Useful phrases from the article

PHRASE	MEANING
brace ourselves for	prepare for
adapt to	adjust to

The 20 new words

WORD		MEANING	EXAMPLE
erosion	n	the wearing away of land by water or wind	*Coastal erosion threatens the village.*
glacier	n	a huge mass of slowly moving ice	*The glacier has shrunk by half.*
earthquake	n	a sudden shaking of the ground	*The earthquake destroyed many houses.*
volcano	n	a mountain that sends out hot rock	*The volcano erupted last spring.*
tide	n	the regular rise and fall of the sea	*The tide comes in twice a day.*
altitude	n	height above sea level	*Air is thinner at high altitude.*
terrain	n	the type of land	*The terrain is rough and rocky.*
arid	adj	very dry	*Arid regions receive little rain.*

humid	adj	containing a lot of moisture	*The climate is hot and humid.*
flood	n	water covering normally dry land	*The flood destroyed the harvest.*
hurricane	n	a violent storm with strong winds	*The hurricane hit the coast at night.*
latitude	n	distance north or south of the equator	*Countries at high latitude have long winters.*
tropical	adj	from the hot, wet regions near the equator	*Tropical forests are rich in species.*
ocean current	n	a steady flow of water in the sea	*Ocean currents affect the climate.*
sea level	n	the average height of the ocean	*Sea level is rising each year.*
landscape	n	all the features of an area of land	*The landscape is full of lakes.*
tributary	n	a small river that joins a larger one	*The tributary flows into the Nile.*
crust	n	the outer layer of the Earth	*The Earth's crust is made of plates.*
atmosphere	n	the layer of gases around the Earth	*The atmosphere protects us from radiation.*
season	n	one of the four parts of the year	*The rainy season begins in June.*

Revision: 10 words from last week

WORD		MEANING
cognitive	adj	related to thinking and understanding
perception	n	the way you see or understand things
memory	n	the ability to remember
emotion	n	a strong feeling
motivation	n	the reason for doing something
behavior	n	the way a person acts
stimulus	n	something that causes a reaction
subconscious	adj	happening without your knowing
anxiety	n	worry or fear about the future
personality	n	the character of a person

Practice: fill the gaps

tide · earthquake · tributary · hurricane · sea level · crust · latitude · tropical

1. The _____ comes in twice a day.
2. The _____ destroyed many houses.
3. The _____ flows into the Nile.

4. The _____ hit the coast at night.

5. _____ is rising each year.

6. The Earth's _____ is made of plates.

7. Countries at high _____ have long winters.

8. _____ forests are rich in species.

More words on this topic (not in the article: choose the 10 most useful for you)

avalanche (n): a mass of snow falling down a mountain
basin (n): a low area of land
bay (n): a curve of coastline
canyon (n): a deep valley with steep sides
cliff (n): a steep rock face
climate (n): usual weather over a long time
coast (n): land beside the sea
continent (n): a large land mass
crater (n): a bowl-shaped hole
delta (n): land formed at a river mouth
desert (n): a very dry area
equator (n): an imaginary line around the middle of Earth
fault line (n): a crack in the Earth's crust
fertile land (n): land good for growing
gulf (n): a large bay
iceberg (n): a large block of floating ice
island (n): land surrounded by water
lava (n): hot melted rock
monsoon (n): a season of heavy rain
mountain range (n): a chain of mountains
peninsula (n): land almost surrounded by water
plain (n): a large flat area
plateau (n): a high flat area
rainfall (n): the amount of rain
rainforest (n): a dense tropical forest
reef (n): a ridge of rock or coral in the sea
savanna (n): a grassy plain with few trees
tsunami (n): a huge sea wave
wetland (n): land covered with water
wilderness (n): a wild, uninhabited area

Answers

1. tide (tide)
2. earthquake (earthquake)
3. tributary (tributary)
4. hurricane (hurricane)
5. Sea level (sea level)
6. crust (crust)
7. latitude (latitude)
8. Tropical (tropical)